

DAN XU
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17/12/1992

PROFILE

I am an international strategy and business management consultant with 5+ years delivering market intelligence, structured analysis, and commercial recommendations to decision-makers across Asia-Pacific markets. I collect my own market intelligence, structure problems for decision-makers, and deliver measurable outcomes: at Nomura Research Institute Shanghai I managed 4+ client engagements per month across financial services, healthcare, and consumer goods; at Rakuten Group (Shanghai) I won an exclusive-distributor bid against two competing agencies within six months, completed five major consulting projects in five months while reaching 132% of GMV and gross profit targets across 8+ Japanese brands management. Earlier at YRGLM Inc. (Tokyo) I exceeded lead-generation targets by 123% and contributed to 110% year-on-year revenue growth. Based in Bochum, Germany, I am seeking a client-facing international consulting or strategic business development role — market entry, growth advisory, and cross-border expansion where English is the primary working language (€55,000–65,000; German B1, progressing toward B2).

SKILLS:

- Market Entry Strategy & Growth Strategy
- Business Development
- Business Assessment & Investment Evaluation
- Cross-Border Market Expansion
- Project Management
- Stakeholder Management
- Data Analysis(Excel, Thinkcell, PowerPoint)
- AI-augmented research & workflow design (Cursor); structured application; Web portfolio(GitHub)

EXPERIENCE

Nomura Research Institute Shanghai Limited

• Mar 2023 – Dec 2024

Consultant - Business Management Consulting

- Supported market entry, business expansion, and strategic assessment projects for corporate clients across Asia-Pacific(APAC) markets, covering both B2B and B2C industries.
- Evaluated market attractiveness, competitive positioning, regulatory environments, and investment opportunities across new energy vehicles, financial services, healthcare, and consumer goods sectors.
- Delivered executive-level strategic proposal through industry analysis, competitor benchmark, and business assessments to support client growth and investment decisions.
- Managed 4+ consulting projects simultaneously per month, coordinating cross-functional teams across Japan, China, India, and Southeast Asia to ensure timely project delivery.
- Identified new business opportunities through market intelligence and consumer trend analysis, developing product prioritization frameworks and growth strategies to support market expansion decisions.

Selected Projects

- **Financial Service: Stock Market External Factor Assessment & Growth Scenario Analysis**
 - Designed an integrated assessment framework covering macroeconomic growth, monetary policy, market valuation, earnings outlook, and geopolitical factors to identify key external drivers influencing client share price performance.

- Conducted correlation and regression analyses across banking sector indices, conglomerate benchmarks, and major equity markets to evaluate performance drivers and market sensitivities.
- Developed forward-looking growth scenarios and strategic recommendations supporting management's medium-term business and investment planning.
- **Healthcare: China PAP Business Strategy Review & Growth Opportunity Assessment**
 - Assessed the client's China PAP business medium-to-long-term strategy through market, competitor, pricing, channel, and service-model analysis.
 - Developed a strategic benchmark framework covering leading industry players and evaluated commercial models, channel effectiveness, and customer service capabilities.
 - Identified strategic gaps, growth opportunities, and operational improvement areas, delivering recommendations that supported management's future business planning and growth priorities.
- **Consumer Goods: Japanese Product Portfolio Prioritization & China Growth Strategy**
 - Developed a category prioritization framework covering 20+ product concepts and shortlisted 10 high-potential opportunities based on market attractiveness, competition intensity, consumer demand, and development feasibility.
 - Conducted competitor benchmark, consumer insight analysis, and social-media trend assessments to identify differentiated growth opportunities.
 - Translated market intelligence into product portfolio recommendations, commercialization roadmaps, and medium-term growth strategies supporting investment and product development decisions.
- **Cases Study Link:** <https://dankyoni.github.io/casestudy.html>

Rakuten Group, Inc.

• Mar 2021 – Mar 2023

Market Entry & Business Development Consultant

- Led a key exclusive-distributor bidding project within six months of joining the company, securing the contract against two competing agencies through differentiated market entry, branding, and commercial strategies.
- Advised Japanese companies on China market entry, business growth, and expansion initiatives through regulatory, market, customer, competitor, and internal business analyses.
- Independently managed consulting-related market research and project delivery activities, completing five major consulting projects within five months and translating findings into actionable growth strategies.
- Led cross-functional project execution across sales, operations, media, and business management teams to ensure successful delivery of strategic initiatives.
- Developed e-commerce growth strategies covering brand positioning, digital marketing, sales operations, and channel development, achieving 132% of Gross Merchandise Volume(GMV) and Gross Profit(GP) targets across 8+ Japanese brands.

Selected Projects

- **China Market Entry & Exclusive Distributor Bidding Strategy - Color Shampoo Brand**
 - Led strategy development for a competitive China market-entry, bid acquisition against competing agencies, secured a long-term appointment as a general agent.
 - Developed brand positioning and differentiation strategy based on market trend analysis, competitor benchmark, and category insights.
 - Structured commercial operations strategy covering marketing execution, sales growth mechanisms, and pricing strategy.
 - Built a joint business and revenue model for both the client and Rakuten, including financial simulation and scenario analysis, which supported internal approval for new business expansion.
- **TikTok New Business Incubation & Growth Strategy Project**
 - Supported the development of a new TikTok-based business initiative to diversify growth beyond traditional e-commerce channels, creating business cases, risk-mitigation scenarios, and a three-year growth roadmap.
 - Conducted ROI assessments and investment analyses, translating commercial opportunities into strategic recommendations that supported executive decision-making and internal approval processes.

- Facilitated cross-functional stakeholder alignment and successfully onboarded three brands during launch, contributing to a 20% sales increase for the first activated brand.

YRGLM Inc. (Tokyo)

• Apr 2019 – Mar 2021

Marketing Analyst & Business Development Specialist

- Developed new business with Japanese e-commerce companies through needs-based assessments and solution-based advisory presentations.
- Exceeded lead-generation targets by 123% and contributed to 110% year-on-year revenue growth through data-driven market analysis and business development initiatives.
- Achieved 50% new-business conversion rate through relationship-led engagement.
- Designed and executed multi-channel marketing initiatives to improve campaign effectiveness and support sales KPI achievement.

Career transition / Freelance commercial market research

• Dec 2024 – Present

- Relocated to Germany (based in Bochum since Jan 2026); German B1, working toward B2; targeting English-primary international BD / commercial roles with employer-sponsored work permit.
- Freelance commercial market research for consumer goods clients: category and channel analysis, competitive and pricing checks, executive-ready summaries and steering-style deliverables.
- Representative freelance engagement: China market-entry research for Japanese maternity & baby brand (maternity & baby) — regulatory standards scan, category sizing, competitive price-band benchmarking, channel review, branding strategy.

LANGUAGES

- Chinese - Native
- English - Professional Working Proficiency
- Japanese - Professional Working Proficiency
- German - B1 (actively progressing toward B2)

EDUCATION:

- Master of Practical Sociology Science for SDGs , Hokkaido University – Sapporo, Japan | Apr 2017 – Mar 2019
- Bachelor of Landscape Design, Chengdu University – Sichuan, China | Apr 2011 – Mar 2015